

Question ID: 926c246b

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Nonlinear functions	Medium

Question

$D = 5,640(1.9)^t$

The equation above estimates the global data traffic D, in terabytes, for the year that is t years after 2010. What is the best interpretation of the number 5,640 in this context?

Answer

- A. The estimated amount of increase of data traffic, in terabytes, each year
- B. The estimated percent increase in the data traffic, in terabytes, each year
- C. The estimated data traffic, in terabytes, for the year that is t years after 2010
- D. The estimated data traffic, in terabytes, in 2010

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. Since t represents the number of years after 2010, the estimated data traffic, in terabytes, in 2010 can be calculated using the given equation when $t = 0$. Substituting 0 for t in the given equation yields $D = 5,640(1.9)^0$, or $5,640(1) = 5,640$. Thus, 5,640 represents the estimated data traffic, in terabytes, in 2010.

Choice A is incorrect. Since the equation is exponential, the amount of increase of data traffic each year isn't constant. Choice B is incorrect. According to the equation, the percent increase in data traffic each year is 90%. Choice C is incorrect. The estimated data traffic, in terabytes, for the year that is t years after 2010 is represented by D, not the number 5,640.